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2144. Minimum Cost of Buying Candies With Discount

Solved 

Easy

 Topics Hint

A shop is selling candies at a discount. For **every two** candies sold, the shop gives a **third** candy for **free**.

The customer can choose **any** candy to take away for free as long as the cost of the chosen candy is less than or equal to the **minimum** cost of the two candies bought.

- For example, if there are 4 candies with costs 1, 2, 3, and 4, and the customer buys candies with costs 2 and 3, they can take the candy with cost 1 for free, but not the candy with cost 4.

Given a **0-indexed** integer array `cost`, where `cost[i]` denotes the cost of the i^{th} candy, return the **minimum cost** of buying **all** the candies.

Example 1:

Input: `cost = [1,2,3]`

Output: 5

Explanation: We buy the candies with costs 2 and 3, and take the candy with cost 1 for free.

The total cost of buying all candies is $2 + 3 = 5$. This is the **only** way we can buy the candies.

Note that we cannot buy candies with costs 1 and 3, and then take the candy with cost 2 for free.

</> Code

Java  Auto

```
1 class Solution {
2     public int minimumCost(int[] cost) {
3         Arrays.sort(cost);
4         int total = 0;
5         int n = cost.length;
6         for (int i = n - 1; i >= 0; i--) {
7             // i counted from the end: skip e
8             if ((n - 1 - i) % 3 != 2) {
9                 total += cost[i];
10            }
11        }
12        return total;
13    }
14 }
```

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You must